preprint · October 25, 2026

The Preprint Theme for Beamer

Lecture slides that read like a paper

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Abstract. This deck demonstrates the Preprint theme: a paper-like look with numbered sections, an abstract, equations, citations and captioned figures, for lectures and reading groups.

Agenda

1 Getting started

2 Paper features

3 Text and maths

4 Blocks and overlays

5 Tables and figures

6 Closing

§1

Getting started

1 Using the theme

Load the theme and set your metadata in the preamble:

preamble.tex

```
\documentclass[aspectratio=169]{beamer}
\usetheme{Preprint}
\title{...}  \author{...}  \institute{...}  \date{\today}
\preprintid{[preprint]~~talk~~\textperiodcentered~~2026}   % vertical
    margin ID
\preprintabstract{One-paragraph summary shown on the title slide.}
```

Start the document with `\titleframe` and compile with **XeLaTeX** twice.

1 Options at a glance

Flags

Pass as `\usetheme[...]{Preprint}`:

`nosectionpages`, `nocredit`

Special frames

`\titleframe` opens the talk.
`\thanksframe{..}{..}` closes it.
Section slides appear for every `\section`.

§2

Paper features

2 Abstracts, citations and equations

Abstract. We show how a paper-like layout keeps dense material readable: numbered sections, short paragraphs and numbered equations.

Linear regression predicts each target as a weighted sum of the inputs [1]:

$$\hat{y} = w^{\top} x + b \tag{1}$$

The weights minimise the mean squared error on the training set.

[1] [Author], [*Textbook title*], [Publisher, year].

2 Figures with captions

Figures get a bold numbered caption, set small, just like in a paper.

The vertical ID on the left edge carries your talk title and date.

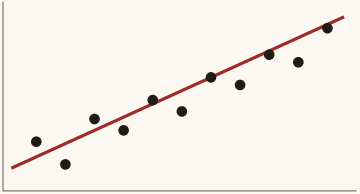


Figure 1. Least-squares fit on sample data.

§ 3

Text and maths

3 Lists

- Items use the theme's bullet
  - Sub-items get a smaller marker
- Alerted text uses the alert colour
- Keep bullets short

(1) Enumerate is styled too
(2) One idea per slide
(3) Let the figure talk

3 Mathematics

Trapezoidal rule

$$\int_a^b f(x)\,dx \;\approx\; \frac{h}{2}\Big[f(x_0) + 2\sum_{i=1}^{n-1} f(x_i) + f(x_n)\Big]$$

Note

Maths keeps Computer Modern, which pairs well with the text fonts.

§ 4

Blocks and overlays

4 Blocks

BLOCK

Beamer's own block, restyled.

ALERTBLOCK

For warnings and pitfalls.

EXAMPLEBLOCK

For examples and tips.

4 Overlays work as usual

- First this

4 Overlays work as usual

- First this
- Then this

4 Overlays work as usual

- First this
- Then this
- And finally this

§ 5

Tables and figures

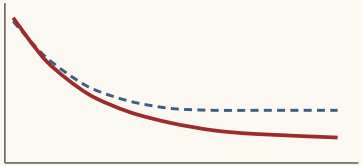
5 A table

config	time (s)	memory (MB)	speed-up
small	31.3	457	2.8
medium	52.6	946	2.8
large	118.4	2505	3.6

Sample numbers for illustration.

5 A figure next to text

- Left column carries the story
- Right column holds the figure
- Use `onlytextwidth` to stay inside the margins



Sample curves: train and validation loss

§6

Closing

6 Summary

(1) Cream paper, serif type and a dark red accent
(2) Numbered section titles and a vertical preprint ID on every slide
(3) Title slide with an abstract between rules
(4) `abstractbox`, `\figcaption` and `\reference`
(5) `\titleframe` and `\thanksframe`

Questions?

[your.email@example.com]